

Xiaoyue Zhang

CONTACT INFORMATION	DIW Berlin Firms and Markets Department Mohrenstraße 58 10117 Berlin Germany	<i>Tel:</i> +31644428635 (Europe) +16172568868 (the USA) <i>E-mail:</i> xzhang@diw.de xyzhang1@mit.edu <i>Web:</i> www.xiaoyuezhang.net
RESEARCH FIELD	Empirical industrial organization	
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Misallocation, productivity, technological progress, industrial policies, environmental economics, dynamic structural analysis	
EDUCATION	Tilburg University , Tilburg, the Netherlands	
	Ph.D., Econometrics	2023
	Research Master in Economics	2019
	Supervisors: Jaap H. Abbring, Jeffrey R. Campbell, Christoph B. T. Walsh	
	KU Leuven , Leuven, Belgium	
	Visiting Ph.D. student	2022
	Host: Jo Van Biesebroeck	
	London School of Economics and Political Science , London, the UK	
	M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics (with Merit)	2016
	Johns Hopkins University , Baltimore, the USA	
	B.A. in Economics (with Honors, the Dean's list)	2015
	Wuhan University , Wuhan, China	
	B.A. in Mathematics (with Honors)	2013
	B.A. in Finance (with Honors)	
WORK EXPERIENCE	DIW Berlin , Berlin, Germany	2025-Present
	Research Associate	
	- Conduct independent academic research - Author policy papers on industrial policies	
	MIT , Cambridge, the USA	
	Visiting Scholar at Sloan	2025-Present
	Post-Doctoral Associate at Sloan, CEEPR, and Climate & Sustainability Consortium	2023-2024
	- Lead two research projects - Directly engage the senior management of Inditex to discuss research design	
	Tilburg University , Tilburg, the Netherlands	
	Teaching Assistant of Quantitative Methods	2019-2023
	- Taught tutorials of a graduate-level course on probability theory, statistics, and optimization - Responsible for answering students' questions and grading assignments	

- Teaching Assistant of Dynamic Economic Models
- Taught labs and tutorials of a graduate-level course on dynamic structural models and estimation
- Responsible for answering students' questions, creating and grading assignments

Wuhan University, Wuhan, China **2019**

- Instructor
- Taught introduction workshops on Git, Github, Jupyter Notebook, L^AT_EX, and R Markdown.

CIECC, Beijing, China **2017**

- Intern
- Studied the effectiveness of government subsidy on new energy vehicles
- Collected and analyzed data on sales and R&D expenditure
- Used a simple OLS regression to show the correlations between policy changes and new energy vehicle companies's sales and R&D expenditure

Capital Group, Beijing, China **2013**

- Intern
- Researched and compared relevant water purification technologies
- Suggested cooperation with Wuhan University to add a ultraviolet process
- Initiated a business plan suggesting focusing on portable water purification devices according to current technological strengths and weaknesses

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Tilburg University

- Jenny Ligthart Award, Best Research Master Student Continuing onto Ph.D. **2019**
- Alumni Scholarship **2019**
- Koopmans Scholarship **2018**

Wuhan University

- First-Class Scholarship **2010**

PUBLICATIONS

X. Zhang. "An Analysis of the Rise and Fall of the Roman Empire." Emergence and Transfer of Wealth 02, no. 03 (2012): 39–47. <https://doi.org/10.12677/ETW.2012.23013>.

WORKING PAPERS & WORK IN PROGRESS

X. Zhang and J. Xia. "The Aggregate Labor Share and Distortions in China." Job market paper, [paper](#).

X. Zhang and J. Xia. "Productivity Cost of Distortions in China." [paper](#).

X. Zhang. "Range-Based Subsidies and Product Upgrading of Electric Vehicles in China." [paper](#).

X. Zhang, M. Demirer, J. Li. "Pollution Abatement and Productivity in US Fossil-Fueled Power Plants."

COMPUTER SKILLS

Statistical software and computer language: extensive use of R and MATLAB; some experience with SAS and Python.
Applications: L^AT_EX, Git, Jupyter Notebook, markdown, and presentation software.

OTHER ACTIVITIES	Organizer of Tilburg Structural Econometrics Group	2021-2022
	Founder and organizer of Graduate Students' Society Book Club	2019-2022
	Panelist for the re-accreditation and the NVAO assessment of the research master program at the Tinbergen Institute	2020
LANGUAGES	Native Chinese, fluent English, intermediate Dutch (CEFR: B1), intermediate French, basic German (CEFR: A1).	
PERSONAL	Dutch citizen	
JOURNAL SERVICE	Referee: Journal of the European Economic Association	
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	"Pollution Abatement and Productivity in US Fossil-Fueled Power Plants." MIT Climate & Sustainability Consortium symposium. 2024 "The Aggregate Labor Share and Distortions in China." Tilburg Structural Econometrics Group, the GSS seminar at Tilburg University, the ENTER Jamboree, the IAAE annual conference. 2023 "Productivity Cost of Distortions in China" (circulated earlier as "Misallocation under Heterogeneous Markups and Non-Constant Returns to Scale") Tilburg Structural Econometrics Group, the GSS seminar at Tilburg University, the IO seminars at KU Leuven, the ENTER Jamboree, China International Conference in Macroeconomics, the IAAE annual conference, the AMES China meeting, and China Center for Economic Research's Summer Institute, the NSE International Annual Workshop, the EEA-ESEM summer meeting. 2020-2022 "Range-Based Subsidies and Product Upgrading of Electric Vehicles in China" (circulated earlier as "Optimal Subsidies for the Product Upgrading of Battery Electric Vehicles in China") The virtual IO CEPR event, Tilburg Environmental Group, Leuven Summer Event, NEUDC. 2022 "A Forgotten Bright Side: Technology Spillovers from SOEs Support Industrial Upgrade." Workshop at Wuhan University 2019	
WORKING PAPERS AND ABSTRACTS	The Aggregate Labor Share and Distortions in China, job market paper, with J. Xia. Abstract: This paper quantifies the impact of distortions that hinder firms from using profit-maximizing amount of capital and labor on the labor share in the aggregate revenue of Chinese manufacturing, mining, and public utilities. This quantification takes into account heterogeneous productivity, technology, and demand elasticities across firms. Using parameters estimated from firm-level data, we find that removing the distortions and holding the aggregate labor and capital supply fixed would raise the labor share by 24 percentage points. This increase in the labor share is driven by a 57% increase in the wage. Productivity Cost of Distortions in China, with J. Xia. Abstract: Predicted total factor productivity (TFP) gains in China from removing the distortions in the allocation of production factor under Hsieh and Klenow (2009)'s framework are, in theory, sensitive to the assumption that demand elasticity is 3 for all the firms and that Chinese firms have the same technology as American firms. However, there is little empirical evidence on how the predicted TFP gains would change if these assumptions are relaxed. Using the framework developed by Zhang and Xia (2025), we find that the average demand elasticity is around 8 with large dispersion and that American firms are more capital-intensive than Chinese firms. 20% of the TFP gains found by Hsieh and Klenow (2009) are caused by replacing the Chinese production technology with US	

technology instead of distortions. Allowing heterogeneous demand elasticities reduce the predicted gains by about 60 percentage points.

[Range-Based Subsidies and Product Upgrading of Electric Vehicles in China](#)

Abstract: This paper estimates the impact of Chinese subsidies to consumers on electric-vehicle (EV) manufacturers' incentives to reduce production costs of driving range. Chinese consumers received subsidies of 16% to 64% of EV market prices if the driving range is above specific thresholds. I find that EV manufacturers respond to the thresholds and that the discontinuous values of subsidies around the thresholds increased the probability of high-market-share manufacturers investing in cost reduction by 25-35 percentage points. This increase more than doubled the investment probability compared to scenarios without subsidies, suggesting that the range-based consumer subsidies encouraged technology adoption and product upgrading.

REFERENCES

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University of Notre Dame
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Tilburg University
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